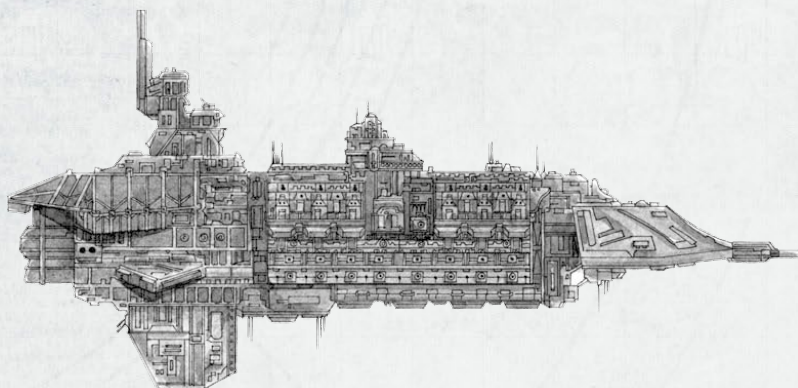


Famous Ships: Guardian of Aquinas (Martian Reserve Fleet), The Sword Infernus (Battlefleet Corona)



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS		
Grand Cruiser/10	20 cm	45°	3	5+	3		
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR		FIRE ARC	
Port weapons battery		30 cm		16		Left	
Starboard weapons battery		30 cm		16		Right	
SPECIAL The Avenger class grand cruiser completely ignore prow critical damage, regardless of the cause. If any critical damage rolled against the table results in a Prow Armament Damaged critical hit, it is assumed the critical damage did not take place, and it does not move up to the next higher critical damage. If the critical damage is caused by the ship taking a hit, the hit itself still counts normally.							

The Avenger is a hang-over from earlier days, and earlier fleet tactics. It is a gun boat, designed as a line-breaker. The squadrons of Avengers would deploy behind a shield of escort vessels or light cruisers. As the fleets closed the range they would accelerate to full speed, racing into the midst of an enemy fleet. Once in the heart of the enemy it would sit, its heavy batteries blazing left and right, trading barrages at point-blank range. The plan called for two or three squadrons of Avengers to cause (and usually take) very heavy damage, but its big batteries could out-shoot most enemies at close quarters. The disruption and damage caused by this brutal tactic of close quarters slugging would leave the enemy fleet in disarray, and easy prey to following waves who could then mop up.

As tactical doctrine changed so the Avenger's place in many Imperial fleets became redundant. The Avenger was relegated from front-line duty. Many had their batteries stripped out for use elsewhere. Some squadrons were mothballed in fleet reserves, but, when hard-pressed, the Avenger can once again be seen racing into the heart of the enemy.